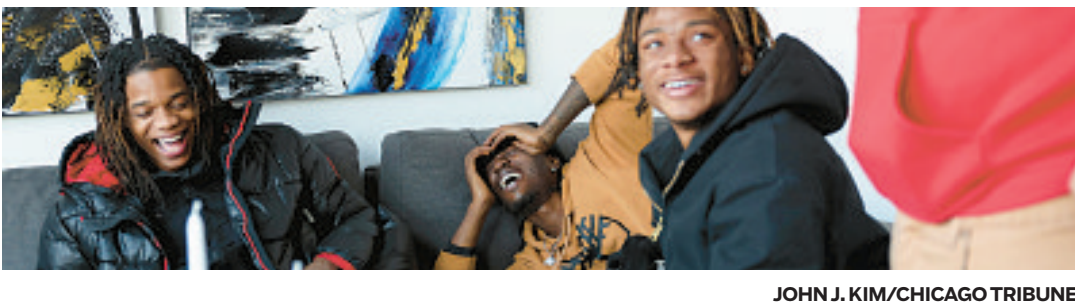


2025 WINTER ARTS

On display

Our top picks around Chicago museums for the season, including Frida Kahlo's return to the Art Institute. Plus, a look at the best art shows, from revisionist surveys to unusual solos. **A+E**



LIFE+TRAVEL

A blueprint for the future

Graduates of Collins Academy in North Lawndale work with their former teacher's nonprofit to design and construct homes for their neighborhood.

JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

WINNER OF 28 PULITZER PRIZES FOR EXCELLENCE IN JOURNALISM

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Chicago Tribune



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SUNDAY, JANUARY 19, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

MICHAEL MADIGAN TRIAL

A pivotal moment, no matter the verdict

Proceedings have put a spotlight on state's often messy politics

By Ray Long, Megan Crepeau and Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

The outcome of former Illinois House Speaker Michael Madigan's corruption trial will be watched closely well beyond Chicago's federal courthouse, with the verdict representing a potential make-or-break moment at the Illinois Capitol.

As the all-important closing arguments in Madigan's case are on track to wrap up by week's end, Democratic Gov. JB Pritzker and state lawmakers must now brace themselves for the culmination of a trial that has put a spotlight on Illinois' messy intersection of money, special interests and power politics.

A guilty verdict in the landmark bribery and racketeering case would give elected officials little place to hide. Some observers say the unending marching line of state, city and suburban officials who have gone to prison already provides a strong incentive to get serious about enacting reforms, but a Madigan conviction would certainly underscore it.

"If not now, when? Why not?" asked Connie Mixon, an Elmhurst University political science professor who testified as an expert for federal prosecutors in the 2023 trial that sent longtime 14th Ward Ald. Edward M. Burke to prison. "Over the years, we've had lots of talk of ethics reform with not nearly enough action."

Madigan, 82, a Southwest Side Democrat, and his co-defendant, Michael McClain, 77, a former ComEd lobbyist and confidant, have pleaded not guilty to wide-ranging charges alleging they illicitly squeezed ComEd and AT&T Illinois to give their allies jobs and contracts. Madigan is also accused of abusing his public duties to garner property-tax business for his private law firm.

After three months of evidence featuring more than 60 witnesses and scores of wiretapped recordings and undercover videos, closing arguments are slated to begin Wednesday and last for three days. The jury is expected to start deliberating the week of Jan. 27, with a

Turn to Trial, Page 4

Now in their 90s, Sisters of Mercy nuns have spent their lives advocating for immigrant justice — and they're not stopping now



THEIR FIGHT ISN'T OVER

By Nell Salzman | Chicago Tribune

Sister JoAnn Persch and Sister Pat Murphy used to set up a sacred space in the McHenry County Jail library once a week for immigrant detainees.

The men held there — who could connect with their families only by phone — would file into the room in orange jumpsuits and take a seat. The sisters would offer a hand. And they would listen to stories about the men's sons and mothers a world away.

"We used to fight against solitary confinement," Persch, now 90, recalled.

Persch and Murphy, who is 95, have devoted their lives advocating for local and federal immigration legislation to fix a broken system. They've been arrested four times at demonstrations. They've fought for detained immigrants to gain more access to pastoral care. They've been foster moms.

The sisters have seen a lot of change in their time advocating for immigrants. But their fight isn't over.

President-elect Donald Trump's promise to enact mass deportations — potentially starting in just a few days — would go beyond anything they could have imagined when they started this work decades ago. To prepare, they said they're ordering informational cards and packets from nonprofits to pass out to families.

"What could happen to these people is extremely important," Murphy said. "(Trump's) words ... the way he talks about immigrants. It's an act of disrespect. Complete disrespect."

While it's unclear what Trump will do after his inauguration on Monday, Chicago is considered one of the targets for an immigration

Turn to Sisters, Page 8

Above: Sister Pat Murphy, 95, center, greets John Owens, left, before a prayer service for immigrants outside of Immigration and Customs Enforcement's Broadview Service Staging facility on Dec. 6. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

INSIDE: Community leaders tell Chicagoans to know their rights in case ICE raids begin after Trump's inauguration. **Page 3**

State bill would end road tests for many older drivers



Patricia Mackin, 86, starts her vehicle before a road test Wednesday at the seniors-only DMV center at the Evanston Civic Center. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

By Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

Seated with a cane at her side, 86-year-old Patricia Mackin waited patiently inside a suburban senior citizens' driver's services facility to be called to take her road test, a requirement for people her age if they want to continue being licensed to drive.

With a few minutes to spare before being escorted by a DMV employee to her car, Mackin reflected on the importance of the testing as Illinois lawmakers consider eliminating the road test requirement for drivers until they turn 87. Illinois now requires anyone 79 and older to take the behind-the-wheel exams in order to get their licenses renewed.

"I think that it makes people much more alert to the fact that

Turn to Tests, Page 11

INSIDE



JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Cubs manager more hands-on for 2025

Will Craig Counsell's involvement in roster construction lead to more wins? Plus, Tom Ricketts talks expectations. **Chicago Sports**

DC rushes to move inauguration indoors

President-elect Donald Trump goes to Washington to celebrate ahead of his second inauguration, which is at noon Monday. **Nation & World**

TODAY'S WEATHER

COLD

High 10

Low -1

Complete forecast on Opinion, Page 12

\$5.75 city and suburbs and elsewhere
177th year No. 19 © Chicago Tribune

